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1. Objective & Scope

This policy defines the expectations, guidelines, and procedures governing employee attendance, working hours, and time-off tracking. Maintaining consistent attendance is critical to operational workflow and business continuity. This policy applies to all full-time employees operating under the General Shift framework.

2. Attendance Cycle & Payroll Integration

To ensure streamlined financial reconciliation, the operational attendance tracker is structurally decoupled from the standard calendar month. The timeline for accounting and payroll processing is detailed below:

- **Attendance Cycle Period:** 20th of the current month to the 19th of the subsequent month.
- **Payslip Generation:** 25th day of every calendar month.
- **Salary Disbursement:** Last working day of the calendar month.

3. Working Schedule, Shifts, & Delivery Mode

The company operates on a structured six-day schedule designed to maximize productivity and meet business demands.

- **Working Days:** Monday through Saturday.
- **Weekly Holiday:** Sunday is designated as the standard weekly off-day.
- **Standard Working Hours:** 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM.
- **Assigned Shift:** General Shift framework.
- **Operating Mode:** Strictly Work from Office (WFO). Physical presence at the designated office location is mandatory.

4. Attendance Tracking & Grace Period

Accurate time tracking provides transparency and serves as the baseline for payroll generation.

- **Authentication Mechanism:** Employees must record their entry and exit exclusively using their company-issued ID card at the designated swipe stations. Failing to swipe both in and out may result in an unexcused or incomplete day log.
- **Grace Time Protocol:** Recognizing occasional transit delays, a standard **15-minute** grace window is permitted at the beginning of the shift. Employees may log in up to **9:15 AM** without immediate penalty. Arrivals after 9:15 AM are officially categorized as late arrivals.

5. Designated Daily Break Timings

To sustain optimal performance, employees are allocated a series of regular breaks throughout the workday. These breaks must be adhered to without extending past the allocated time bounds:

- Morning Tea Break: 11:15 AM to 11:30 AM (15 Minutes)
- Lunch Break: 1:00 PM to 1:45 PM (45 Minutes)
- Evening Tea Break: 4:15 PM to 4:30 PM (15 Minutes)

6. Flexible Working Hours & Core Target Commitments

While standard hours are fixed, operational flexibility is supported to accommodate personal constraints under specific criteria:

- **Early Logout Provision:** Employees may execute an early logout prior to 5:00 PM on any given day, provided their immediate operational tasks allow it and the departure does not negatively affect business functions.
- **Weekly Target Requirement:** The primary condition for utilizing early logouts is that the employee must fulfil a total target of 48 hours worked per week. Any deficit in the weekly target hours must be balanced across other working days within the same week.

7. Overtime Compensation Framework

Additional workloads extending beyond the regular daily schedule or the weekly 48-hour threshold must be handled in accordance with corporate standards:

- **Hourly Compensation:** Verified overtime hours will be compensated directly on an hourly basis.
- **Pre-Approval Mandate:** Overtime is not self-assigned. Compensation eligibility requires formal, documented prior approval from the respective Department Manager before the additional hours are logged. Unapproved extensions will not qualify for financial payout.

8. Short-Duration Permissions

To minimize full-day or half-day absenteeism for brief personal errands or medical appointments, the company grants monthly short-duration allowances:

- **Allocation Quota:** Employees are eligible to request up to 4 hours of total permission time per month.
- **Valid Criteria:** This allowance is explicitly reserved for unexpected medical issues or urgent family emergency reasons.
- **Governance:** Permission requests must be submitted to the direct supervisor as early as possible to avoid unexpected desk coverage issues.

9. Time-Off & Leave Management

Leave allocation aims to help employees rest while maintaining a baseline level of business coverage.

9.1 Paid Time Off & Casual Leaves

- **Annual Entitlement:** Employees receive a maximum allocation of 10 days of Paid Time Off (PTO) per calendar year.
- **Application Protocol:** Casual leaves must be requested well in advance.
- **Approval Authority:** Leave utilization is contingent on direct approval from the Manager. The management reserves the right to defer leave requests if they conflict with critical project milestones or threaten to disrupt regular business operations.

9.2 Unplanned Absences & Sick Leaves

- **Notification Mandate:** In cases of sudden illness or unexpected medical emergencies, employees must immediately notify their Team Lead or Department Manager via an email or a phone call before or at the start of their shift.
- **System Logging:** Following verbal or email communication, the employee must officially apply for and document the sick leave through the Employee Self-Service (ESS) portal upon returning to duty or as soon as they have digital access.

10. Tardiness, Corrective Actions, & Loss of Pay (LOP)

Consistent punctuality is a core expectation. The company enforces a clear disciplinary path for chronic late arrival:

1. **First Instance:** Chronic or repeated tardiness will initially result in a formal verbal warning delivered by the immediate supervisor or human resources representative.
2. **Second Instance:** If the pattern of tardiness continues past the verbal warning, the employee will receive a formal written disciplinary notice via email, which will be archived in their employment record.
3. **Financial Escalation Structure (LOP):** Continued late arrivals beyond the grace window (9:15 AM) will trigger an automatic Loss of Pay (LOP) penalty. Specifically, every 3 unexcused late arrivals within a single attendance cycle will result in a half-day (0.5) Loss of Pay deduction.
4. **Payroll Reconciliation:** The financial deductions accrued from the 3-strike late coming penalty will be automatically calculated and deducted from the employee's salary in the next payroll/salary cycle.